

Gatepost Partners is building a regional **residential and commercial pest control** company across **North Carolina, South Carolina, Virginia, and Tennessee**. It starts with one founding business with **\$500 thousand to \$3 million of EBITDA**, then grows as neighboring operators join as partners. Owners receive cash at closing, can **roll equity into the combined company**, and keep their name on the truck and their crew on the routes. Our equity is committed before a letter of intent is signed.

INVESTMENT APPROACH

FOUNDING COMPANY	PARTNER COMPANIES	TRANSACTION	MANAGEMENT
\$500k to \$3mm EBITDA, with owner add-backs	\$150k to \$1mm EBITDA, near existing routes	Majority Recap Optional equity rollover	Welcome to Stay Invested, never required

THE THESIS

- **Needed in every economy.** A \$14.2bn North American market, growing 6.4% a year over the last decade.
- **Recurring by nature.** About 75% of the industry leader's business is recurring service.
- **Fragmented below the top.** Two national firms hold roughly half the market; thousands of strong local operators hold the rest.
- **Density pays.** More stops on the same streets lifts technician productivity at nearly the same cost.
- **A growing region.** Raleigh–Durham, coastal Carolina, Richmond, and Tennessee suburbs keep adding households.

Sources: Rentokil Initial FY2025 results; Rollins FY2025 Form 10-K.

THE PARTNERSHIP

01 The founding company

Chris runs it full-time. The team and name stay.

02 Neighbors join

Adjacent operators add stops on the same streets.

03 Grow together

Shared marketing, systems, and buying power; rolled equity owns a piece of the whole.

THE PLATFORM BRINGS

- Marketing around your routes
- Fast lead response, autopay
- Technician pay and careers
- Back office and compliance

WHAT STAYS YOURS

- Your name and phone number
- Your crew and routes
- A role if you want one
- A stake, if you choose

TARGET SERVICES

Residential Pest	Commercial Pest	Termite and Specialty
▪ Quarterly general pest plans ▪ Mosquito and tick programs ▪ Rodent control and exclusion ▪ Wildlife and stinging insects	▪ Restaurants and food service ▪ Apartments and property managers ▪ Medical, schools, and churches ▪ Warehouses and retail	▪ Termite baiting and renewals ▪ Real estate WDI reports ▪ Crawlspace moisture control ▪ Lawn and ornamental care

ABOUT OUR FOUNDER

Chris Kern founded Gatepost Partners to build a pest control platform alongside the owners who join it. He runs a residential water treatment business, which taught him what a small service company depends on: a technician who shows up, a phone someone answers, and route density. Before that, he spent a handful of years at a lower middle market private equity firm on platform buyouts and add-on acquisitions of founder and family-owned companies, running diligence and financing through closing and working with management teams on budgets, KPIs, and integration. Chris is an MBA candidate at The Wharton School, holds a B.S. in Finance from Florida State University, and plans to move to the market and run the founding company day to day.